Pakistan's concerns about Indian involvement in Balochistan via Afghanistan, Menon (then India's high commissioner to Islamabad) offered to sit down with Musharraf and explain exactly what India was doing in Afghanistan, without asking for a reciprocal explanation.[47] India was also happy with Pakistan conducting 'surprise' checks on Indian consulates in Afghanistan and seeking a detailed reading of its activities if that helped.[48] Islamabad rebuffed the offer. According to Indian officials, talking about Afghanistan with New Delhi was taboo for Pakistan; as such a dialogue risked legitimising India's presence in a country where Pakistan wanted (very) limited Indian presence.

Four months later, on 28 November ten militants entered Mumbai and began a mass rampage. The 26/11 attacks were under way, resulting in the killing of 166 people and injuring more than 600.[49] While there is no corroborative evidence to link these events in Mumbai with the attack on India in Afghanistan, policymakers in New Delhi viewed these developments as direct correlation of their worsening relations with Pakistan. Over the next seven years, more attacks were planned and executed against Indians and Indian installations in Afghanistan. On 8 October 2009 the Indian embassy was bombed again, killing 17 people including three ITBP soldiers, and injuring 83.[50] On 26 February 2010, three Taliban militants stormed two Kabul guesthouses, the Park and the Hamid, which the Indian embassy had rented for its staffers and development workers. Of the eighteen killed, nine were Indians, and among them two were officers of the Indian Army Medical Corps.[51] Maj. Jyotin Singh died while preventing a suicide bomber from entering the Park, and Maj. Nitesh Roy died of 40 per cent burns three days after the attack.[52] The vice consul-general of the Kandahar consulate, which Pakistan actively blamed for fomenting the Baloch insurgency, was also among the dead. A missile attack by the Haqqani network on an Indian NGO in Kunar province killed two Indians in October 2010. In May 2011, the NDS alleged that the ISI had hired two shooters—Sher Zamin and Khan Zamin—to assassinate the Indian consul-general in Jalalabad.[53]

These attacks only reinforced India's emerging policy related learning, which was shaped by the kidnappings between 2003 and 2006, which were (1) not all Afghan Taliban factions took orders from Pakistan, and (2) the neo-Taliban was a highly diverse movement in its social composition, material capacities and